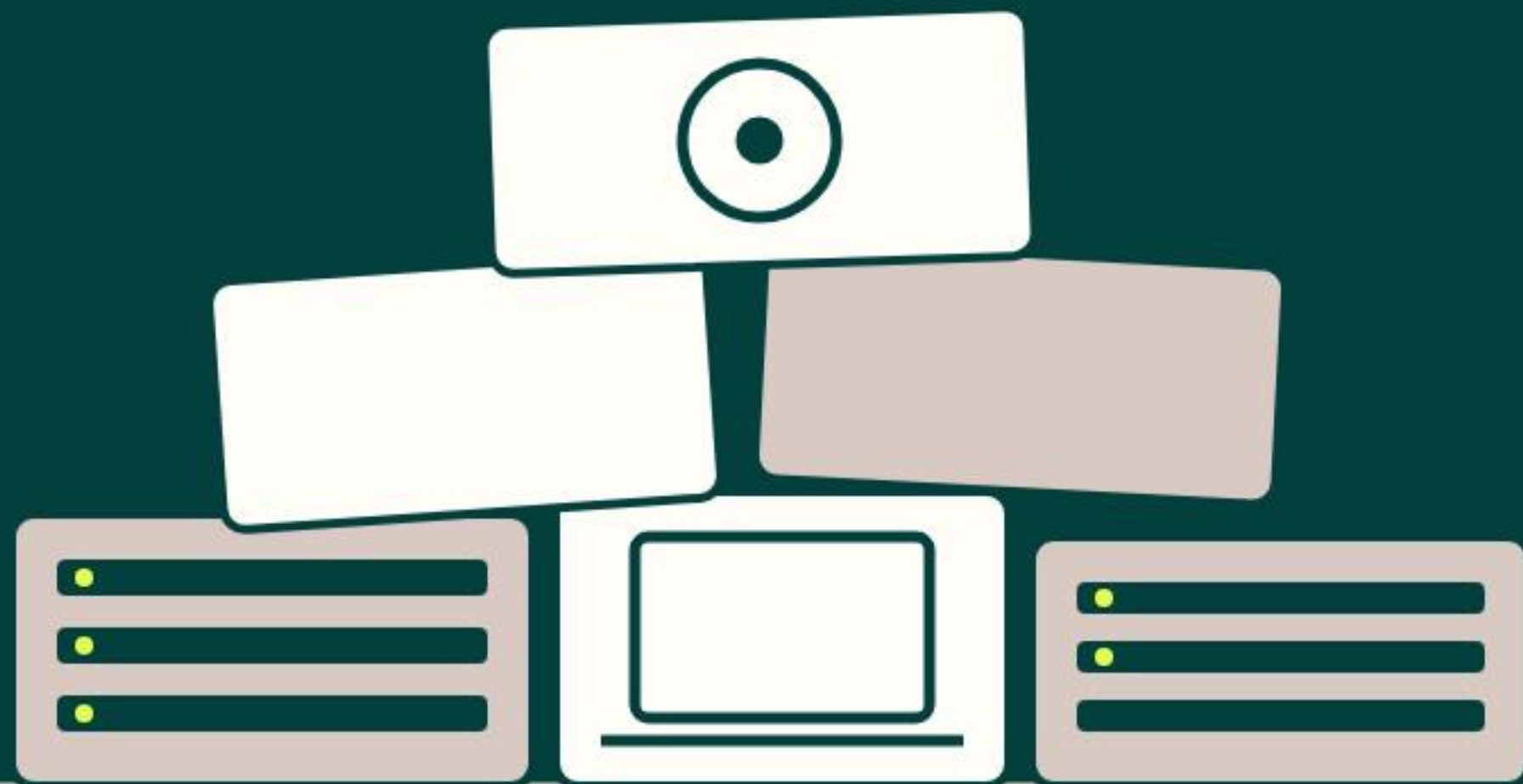


The world threw
away *62 million
tonnes* of electronics
in a single year.



Source: UN Global E-waste Monitor 2024 (ITU/UNITAR): 62 million tonnes generated in 2022.

Data centres *add to the pile.*

Their hardware runs 24×7 and is replaced every few years as it ages or newer, more efficient kit arrives.



Servers



Storage drives

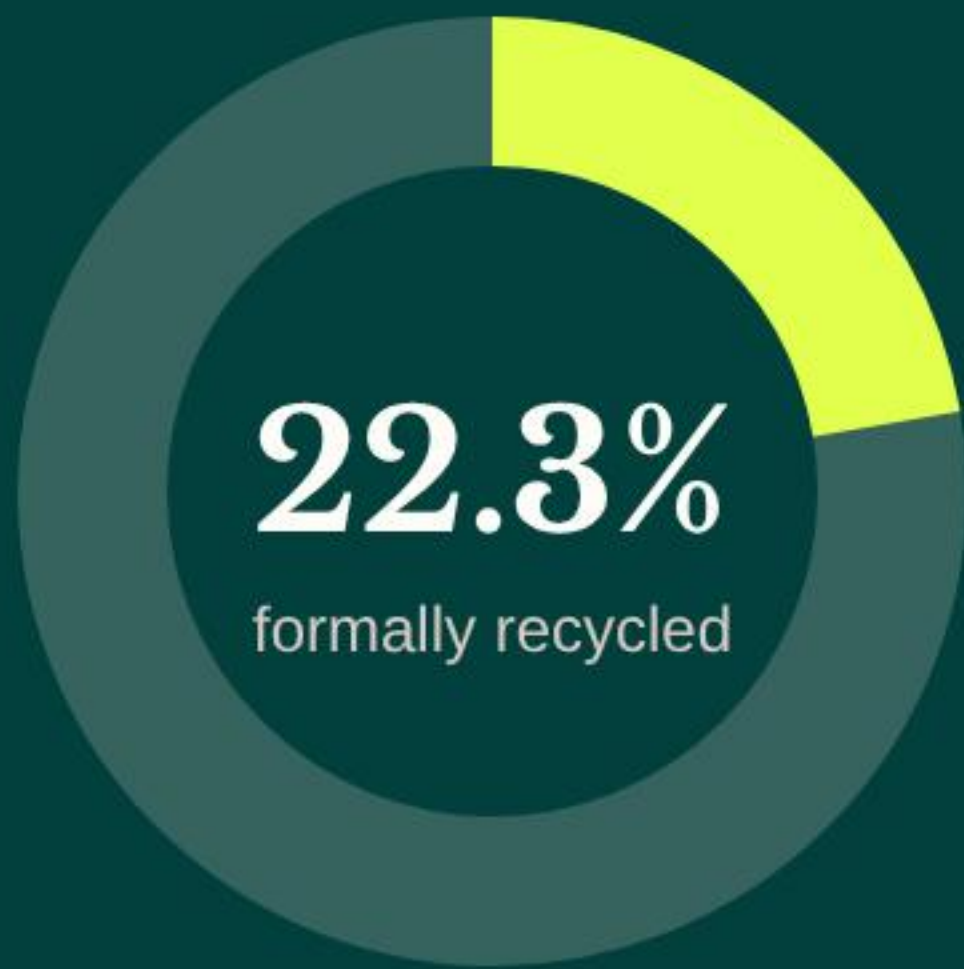


Network
switches



Backup
batteries

Only about *1 in 5* tonnes is properly recycled.



In 2022, just **22.3%** of e-waste was documented as collected and recycled properly.

E-waste is on track to reach **82 million tonnes** a year by 2030.

E-waste is growing almost **five times faster** than documented recycling.

Source: UN Global E-waste Monitor 2024 (ITU/UNITAR).

India's e-waste *nearly doubled* in 7 years.



As India digitises, more devices reach the end of their life, including the hardware inside data centres.

Source: CPCB data, compiled by Dataful/Factly (2025). Figures cover all reported e-waste, not data centres alone.

Treasure and *trouble*, in one box.

Worth recovering

- Gold
- Copper
- Aluminium
- Rare earths

Harmful if dumped

- Lead
- Mercury
- Cadmium
- Flame retardants

Recycled properly, old hardware becomes a resource. Dumped, it becomes a hazard.

India's rules now make *producers responsible*.

The E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2022, in force since April 2023, are built on **Extended Producer Responsibility**.

01 Producers get **yearly recycling targets**

02 Targets are met only through **registered recyclers**

03 Everything is tracked on the **CPCB online portal**

Source: MoEFCC, E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2022 (in force 1 April 2023).

Climb the *circular ladder.*

01 **Extend**

Maintain and upgrade to keep servers running longer

02 **Reuse**

Refurbish and redeploy, resell or donate

03 **Recover**

Harvest working parts for spares

04 **Recycle**

Only with registered recyclers, after secure data wiping

Four questions to ask *your IT partners.*

-  Do you offer hardware take-back at end of life?

-  Are your recyclers registered on the CPCB portal?

-  How is data securely wiped before reuse or recycling?

-  Can refurbished equipment meet some of our needs?

— THE TAKEAWAY

Old servers don't
have to be waste.
*They can be
the next resource.*

NEXT IN THIS SERIES

The one number that shows how
efficient a data centre is

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